One of the factors that made the first month in Stuyvesant Town bearable was that we were looking forward to going off on vacation. We hadn't had one since the disastrous Hilltop Lodge venture of 1944. In 1945, the draft situation made it impossible. In 1946 I was in the Army. In 194-7 * was wor king on research and "Grow Old with Me."

In 1948, we were determined to go, and Gertrude picked out a likely spot from advertisements. It was a place called Chester's Zunbarg in the Catskills.

On August 15, in beautiful weather, we left for the place, and as

soon as we had arrived it seemed we had made the right choice. We got there at 2:00 p.m., just as Sunday midday dinner was concluding, but we were quickly served a steak apiece. Later, after we had unpacked Gertrude went for a swim (she could swim like a fish and dance like a sylph, which made it hard for her, since I could neither swim nor dance).

The people we met were pleasant indeed, especially a nice couple at our table, Jack and Ida Saltzman, who lived in Seagate at the western tip of Coney Island. What's more, the entertainers included one Bernie Hearn, who had amused and pleased us at Allaben Acres in 1942, a connection that was pleasantly nostalgic for me.

We spoke to him afterward quite enthusiastically and described the earlier period of pleasure he had given us. He looked pained and it occurred to me that it might bother him that after six years, his role in show business was still confined to the borscht circuit. I sympathized rather achingly when I thought of all the years that had passed leaving me still at Columbia.

The Saltzmans left on Tuesday morning, but in came Ruth and Isaiah Frank, with whom we grew friendly at once. Isaiah (the only person I ever met who bore the name) worked at the State Department, which was impressive.

Then, too, we met Jack and Shirley Segal (he was tall and a little stout, and she looked rather like Mazie back in Decatur Street). They were going to be moving into Stuyvesant Town soon. We fell on each other's neck, of course.

Also with us was a young woman named Edith, rather small and with a large nose, but quite attractive. She could speak Yiddish even more fluently than I could. I called her "Mammalooshen" (mother tongue), a term often used to mean Yiddish, and we amused ourselves by swapping jokes in Yiddish.

Gertrude joined the arts and crafts group and made a copper pin with a G on